HKU BUSINESS SCHOOL

Master of Business Administration (International)

IMBA6068 Knowledge and Innovation Management

A. GENERAL INFORMATION

Instructor:	Dr. Zhepeng (Lionel) Li
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B. COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course provides students with experiential learning of essential approaches, models, enabling technologies, and effective practices to manage knowledge and innovations in organizations with the help of information technologies. Through this course, students are expected to learn how to appreciate core issues and challenges surrounding knowledge and innovation management in organizational contexts; understand the manager's role and leaderships; apply assessment metrics and integrate appropriate components of knowledge management solutions with reference to specific organizational environments. Upon satisfactory completion of this course, students should have a firm grip of best practices and implementation strategies for knowledge management, become familiar with the processes, issues, and challenges in innovation management that pertain to service, management, and business innovations, and get ready for further study in knowledge generation, engineering, and transfer. Typically, class meetings include in-class lectures and discussions, presentations, and business case analyses and discussions.

Important topics covered in this course include knowledge management concepts, knowledge management solutions, knowledge management assessments, and knowledge-based systems that range over knowledge management in the network-centric era, data-driven knowledge discovery, analytics for online business intelligence, and innovation management.

C. COURSE OBJECTIVES

1) an overall understanding of the essential role of knowledge management in modern organizations
2) core knowledge of prevalent and emerging practices in managing knowledge
3) a sound appreciation of critical issues and challenges in knowledge creating, sharing, and managing
4) in-depth analyses of recommended model(s) that are drawn from best practices in knowledge management
5) a firm grasp of KM solutions in varied managerial contexts

D. PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES

PLO1. Acquisition and internalization of business knowledge and skills in key functional areas

PLO2. Application of business knowledge to solve business problems

PLO3. Development of managerial leadership and inculcating professional ethics and competency in business

PLO4. Development of global outlook

PLO5. Mastering communication skills

E. COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Course Learning Outcomes		**Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes (PLOs)**
CLO1	Acquire a better understanding in global knowledge management across industrial sectors	PLO 1, 4
CLO2	Identify and prioritize opportunities in knowledge management	PLO 1, 2, 3
CLO3	Develop skills in consulting, presentation and team work	PLO 2, 5
CLO4	Apply concepts and approaches learned in the course to analysing, communicating, and designing KM initiatives	PLO 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

F. COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Course Teaching and Learning Activities		**Aligned Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)**
T&L1	Participation	CLO 1, 2
T&L2	Lecturing on concepts, theories and practices	CLO 1, 2, 4
T&L3	Hands-on and discussion-based Case Analysis	CLO 1, 2, 3, 4
T&L4	Group Project	CLO 1, 2, 3, 4
T&L5	Self-reflection on Learning	CLO 2, 3, 4

Assessment Methods		Brief Description	Weight	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes
A1.	Participation	Engagement in the class discussions	30%	CLO1, 4
A2.	Individual Reflection on Learning	A brief summarization within 5 bullet points that describe what are carried away from lecturing and case discussing for the day (4 days in total)	30%	CLO 1, 2, 3, 4
A3.	Group Project Report	A group project report within 10 pages (including diagrams and references)	40%	CLO 1, 2, 3, 4
		Total	100%	

G. STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT

COURSE GRADE DESCRIPTORS	
A+, A, A-	Overall, a very impressive and excellent piece of work, equivalent to a distinction. Includes the majority of the following features: - Demonstrates an understanding of the task which may be beyond what is expected, but which is always relevant. - Original perspective on the problems in question. Contextualization of sources and viewpoints and comprehensive evaluation of contributions. Application of relevant theories in answering the question. - Use of a wide range of relevant sources, well understood and critically evaluated. - Well-structured and organized with a clear line of reasoning. Appropriate length. - Clear, articulate style with accurate spelling, word choice and grammar. Referencing follows consistent academic conventions with all references fully and accurately cited.
B+, B, B-	Overall, a good and commendable piece of work. Includes the majority of the following features: - Demonstrates sound understanding of the task. Presentation of points and arguments generally relevant to the question. - Sustained commentary on evidence and materials used. Inclusion of appropriate critical perspective. Use of theoretical models in a relevant way to answer the question. - Sound understanding of main sources of literature, well summarized and used in a critical and relevant way. - Clear structure and presentation. Control of length - Generally accurate spelling, word choice and grammar. Generally consistent and accurate referencing.
C+, C, C-	Overall, a satisfactory piece of work. Includes the majority of the following features: - Understands main point of the task. Most points and arguments presented are relevant to the question.

COURSE GRADE DESCRIPTORS	
	- Adequate commentary on evidence and materials used. Some evidence of critical awareness. Use and understanding of theoretical models, but in a fairly pedestrian way. - Adequate range of source material consulted. Clear understanding of the literature used. - Good structure and presentation, minor problems in organization do not impede communication. Control of length. - Comprehensible spelling, word choice and grammar, inaccuracies do not impede meaning. Generally consistent referencing.
D+, D	Overall, a bare pass. Includes the majority of the following features: - Understanding of basic concepts and effort made to relate them to the question. - Argument mainly descriptive points and/or points which require greater substantiation. More development of ideas needed to sustain an argument. Identification of main issues, but little critical awareness. - Some evidence of reading and understanding of the literature, but range and /or relevance very limited. - Attempt made at coherent presentation, but ideas not well integrated. - Comprehensible spelling, word choice and grammar, although inaccuracies may sometimes impede meaning. Some attempt at consistent referencing and control of length
F	Overall, a very poor piece of work. Includes the majority of the following features: - Inadequate understanding or misunderstanding of task. Purely descriptive account with little or no analysis. - Irrelevant comments and/or assertions which are not supported by meaningful evidence. Little evidence of integration of various sources to sustain an argument. Lack of any critical or appreciative framework. - Few relevant sources used and/or little use of literature. - Unstructured presentation and/or lack of coherence which impedes understanding. - Little or no attempt at consistent referencing. Major inaccuracies in grammar, word choice and spelling. Length problematic.

H. ASSESSMENT RUBRICS FOR EACH ASSESSMENT

Grade	Course Grade Descriptor
	Group Project
A+, A, A-	- Identifies the topic learned in the field trip clearly and shows good understanding of this topic. - Demonstrates a comprehensive command of existing arguments relevant to the topic. - Shows good application of the topic learned in the field trip. - The report has a clear structure and organization. - The report has very few, if any, errors in grammar and vocabulary.

Grade	Course Grade Descriptor
	- Quoted materials from other sources (with proper citation) are used only to support and strengthen arguments instead of replacing the student's own writing.
B+, B, B-	- Identifies the topic learned in the field trip and shows some understanding of this topic. - Demonstrates a good command of existing arguments relevant to the topic. - Shows some application of the topic learned in the field trip. - The report has some structure and organization. - The report has some errors in grammar and vocabulary. - Quoted materials from other sources (with proper citation) are used to support and strengthen arguments, but sometimes also used to replace the student's own writing.
C+, C, C-	- Identifies the topic learned in the field trip and shows little understanding of this topic. - Demonstrates insufficient command of existing arguments relevant to the topic. - Shows little application of the topic learned in the field trip. - The report is poorly organized. - There are distracting language errors though the overall meaning is still intelligible. - Quoted materials from other sources (with proper citation) are used more to replace the student's own writing than to support and strengthen arguments.
D+, D	- Shows no clear identification of the topic learned in the field trip and little or wrong understanding of this topic. - Demonstrates a lack of understanding of existing arguments relevant to the topic. - Shows no application of the topic learned in the field trip. - The report is poorly organized. - Frequent errors in simple grammar and vocabulary, which are distracting and the overall meaning is not easily intelligible. - Quoted materials from other sources (with proper citation) are heavily used to replace the student's own writing.
F	- Shows no clear identification of the topic learned in the field trip and little or wrong understanding of this topic. - Demonstrates a lack of understanding of existing arguments relevant to the topic. - Shows no application of the topic learned in the field trip. - The report is poorly organized. - Language errors are so frequent and distracting that the report is largely incomprehensible. - Quoted materials from other sources are heavily used to replace the student's own writing, sometimes without proper citation.

I. TEACHING SCHEDULE

Class Date	Content
1/2 AM	Session 1-1: Introduction to KM – Overview Session 1-2: Introduction to KM – Impacts Session 1-3: Introduction to KM – Concepts
1/2 PM	Session 2: Ramp-up Case – World Bank's Transition in KM
1/3 AM	Session 3-1: KM Solutions – Processes Session 3-2: KM Solutions – Systems Session 3-3: KM Solutions – Infrastructures
1/3 PM	Session 4: In-class Demo Lab on Knowledge Filtering with Recommender System
1/4 AM	Session 5-1: Knowledge Engineering – Representation in Retail Banking Session 5-2: Knowledge Engineering – Elicitation & Filtering in Personalization Session 5-3: Knowledge Engineering – Generation in AI & LLM Applications
1/4 PM	Session 6: In-class Case & Discussion: KM in Consulting Business
1/5 AM	Session 7: Innovation Management and Innovator's Dilemma
1/5 PM	Session 8: Guest Speaker's Session – Building New Business Line in Established Firms from the Knowledge Perspective

J. RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS

[Recommended Textbook] Becerra-Fernandez, I., Gonzalez, A., Sabherwal, R., (2004) Knowledge Management: Challenges, Solutions, and Technologies. Pearson Prentice Hall. ISBN: 0-13-101606-7.

[Optional Reading] Clayton M. Christensen. (1997) The Innovator's Dilemma: When New Technologies Cause Great Firms to Fail. Harvard Business School Press, Boston, MA.

[Optional Reading] Dalkir, K. (2017) Knowledge Management in Theory and Practice (3rd edition). MIT Press. ISBN: 978026203687.

*Case materials will be made available on the course Moodle page

K. MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

The Student Feedback on Teaching and Learning (SFTL) questionnaire is one of the ways HKU courses and teaching are evaluated. HKU places significant importance on student learning and on the continuous enhancement of teaching and learning outcomes. Students are asked to complete this evaluation of their learning experiences at the conclusion of each course in which they enrol. Questionnaire items relate to the overall evaluation of the course as well as an evaluation of teaching.

L. COURSE POLICY

The University Regulations on academic dishonesty will be strictly enforced. Please check the University Statement on plagiarism on https://tl.hku.hk/plagiarism/ .

Cheating or plagiarism of any kind would result in an automatic F grade for the course plus strict enforcement of all Faculty and/or University regulations regarding such behavior. Incident(s) of academic dishonesty will NOT be tolerated.

Academic dishonesty is a behavior in which a deliberately fraudulent misrepresentation is employed in an attempt to gain undeserved intellectual credit, either for oneself or for another. It includes, but is not necessarily limited to, the following types of cases:

a. Plagiarism - the representation of someone else's ideas as if they are one's own. Where the arguments, data, designs, etc., of someone else are being used in a paper, report, oral presentation, or similar academic project, this fact must be made explicitly clear by citing the appropriate references. The references must fully indicate the extent to which any parts of the project are not one's own work. Paraphrasing of someone else's ideas is still using someone else's ideas, and must be acknowledged.

b. Unauthorized Collaboration on Out-of-Class Projects - the representation of work as solely one's own when in fact it is the result of a joint effort.

c. Cheating on In-Class Exams - the covert gathering of information from other students, the use of unauthorized notes, unauthorized aids, etc.

d. Unauthorized Advance Access to an Exam - the representation of materials prepared at leisure, as a result of unauthorized advance access (however obtained), as if it were prepared under the rigors of the exam setting. This misrepresentation is dishonest in itself even if there are not compounding factors, such as unauthorized uses of books or notes.

All assignments (i.e. individual papers) will be uploaded to Turnitin for originality checking and to identify potential plagiarism, if any.

Where a candidate for a degree or other award uses the work of another person or persons without due acknowledgement:

1. The relevant Board of Examiners may impose a penalty in relation to the seriousness of the offence.

2. The relevant Board of Examiners may report the candidate to the Senate, where there is *prima facie* evidence of an intention to deceive and where sanctions beyond those in (1) might be invoked.